15.3.2 Shared operational policies

Shared operational policies define rules that span multiple systems, workflows, or environments, but are not broad enough to be foundational. These policies are managed by the functional groups responsible for the systems or workflows they govern, like engineering, operations, finance, or support. They enable teams to articulate cross-system operational requirements without having to embed those rules separately into each application or tool.

These policies are particularly useful for introducing operational nuances across different services or teams. A typical example occurs in deployment workflows. ACME's engineering team wanted a consistent rule for after-hours production deployments. Multiple product groups managed their own deployment pipelines, but the requirement was the same everywhere: Late-night deployments should be performed only by the on-call engineer. Instead of changing each pipeline or relying on each team to apply the requirement correctly, engineering articulated the rule as a shared operational policy that all pipelines could reference when authorizing production changes:

```
forbid(
    principal,
    action == Pipeline::"deploy",
    resource in Pipeline::"production"
)
unless {
    /* During business hours */
    context.time.hour >= 8 && context.time.hour < 18
    ||
    /* After hours, only the on-call engineer may deploy */
    context.oncall.current_engineer == principal
};
```

This forbid-unless structure clarified two concepts:

- Deployment is allowed during normal business hours.
- Outside those hours, deployment is allowed only for the on-call engineer.